



Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: Tuesday, 9:00a.m.	Entry: 1
Description	On Tuesday at 9:00 a.m. a U.S. health care clinic suffered a major ransomware attack that severely disrupted operations. A phishing email with a malicious attachment triggered the incident, encrypting the organization's files once downloaded. An organized hacker group left a ransom note demanding payment in exchange for the decryption key.
Tool(s) used	NA
The 5 W's	Who caused the incident? An organized group of unethical hackers known to target the healthcare and transportation industries. What happened? Employees were unable to access files and software. A ransomware attack encrypted critical files including patient data, and a ransom note was displayed demanding a large sum of money for the decryption key. When did the incident occur? Tuesday morning at approximately 9:00 a.m.

	Where did the incident happen? A small U.S. health care clinic specializing in primary-care services. Why did the incident happen? The attackers gained access by sending targeted phishing emails to employees. Once a malicious attachment was downloaded, malware was installed and ransomware was deployed, encrypting the organization's files.
	Were employees given prior security awareness training to recognize phishing emails? If not, this should be a priority going forward. It's worth investigating how many employees received and opened the phishing email to determine the full scope of the compromise. Did the clinic have a data backup system in place? Offline or cloud backups could have reduced the impact of the encryption. Should the ransom be paid? Paying does not guarantee the decryption key will be provided and may encourage future attacks. The clinic likely has HIPAA compliance obligations — this incident may need to be reported to the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) given that patient data was compromised. Going forward, the organization should implement multi-factor authentication (MFA), email filtering, and endpoint detection tools to reduce the risk of a repeat incident.